SPORTS CURRENT AFFAIRS 2026

January → November 2026 | Competitive Exam Guide with Mnemonics

Winners · Hosts · Editions · Medal tallies · Awards · Records · 24 original mnemonics

READ THIS FIRST

Compiled	3 November 2026
Coverage	1 January 2026 → 3 November 2026
Built for	UPSC · SSC · Banking · Railways · Defence · State PSC · TET

Scope note: November 2026 is only three days old on the compilation date, so this guide covers 1 January to 3 November 2026. Events after that date (Dakar 2026 Youth Olympics through 13 November; Gukesh–Sindarov from 25 November) are flagged UPCOMING and are not presented as results. Where sources disagree, the primary/mainstream source is used — always cross-check the latest monthly capsule before the exam.

WHAT'S INSIDE

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7	25 practice MCQs with answer key
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The Markdown files remain the master copy. This PDF replaces decorative emoji with short text labels and transliterates the Hindi mnemonic phrases into Roman script so every line prints cleanly; all facts, numbers and source links are unchanged.

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For: UPSC CSE / SSC (CGL, CHSL, MTS, GD) / Banking (IBPS, SBI, RBI) / Railways / CDS-NDA-AFCAT / State PSC / TET & all GA-heavy exams **Compiled:** 03 November 2026 (UTC). Coverage: **1 Jan 2026 → 3 Nov 2026**. **Companion file:** `SPORTS_2026_MNEMONICS.md` — one-page last-day revision sheet.

> **Scope note:** November 2026 is only 3 days old on the date of compilation, so November covers 1–3 Nov plus events in progress. Events scheduled after 3 Nov (e.g., the FIDE World Championship from 25 Nov) are flagged as **UPCOMING** and are not presented as results. Where news sources disagree, this guide follows the primary/mainstream source (ICC, BCCI, BWF, FIH, FIFA, Olympics.com, Wikipedia, The Hindu, Indian Express, ESPNcricinfo). A full, link-rich source list is at the end — **always cross-check the latest monthly capsule before the exam.**

How to use this file in 30 minutes

Step	Time	What to do
1	5 min	Read the **Master Calendar** (Section 1) — dates + hosts + winners in one glance
2	8 min	Read the **4 "Big Four" tables** (Section 3: Grand Slams, Cricket, Football, India's medal tallies)
3	7 min	Learn the **Mnemonic Bank** (Section 4) — M1 to M20
4	5 min	Read the **Trap Alerts** (Section 5) — these are exactly where negative marking happens
5	5 min	Attempt the **25 MCQs** (Section 7) and check the answer key

Highest-yield topics for 2026 (do not skip): FIFA World Cup 2026 · T20 World Cup 2026 · Asian Games 2026 (85 medals) · Commonwealth Games 2026 (39 medals) · Asian Para Games 2026 (114 medals) · Winter Olympics 2026 · Grand Slam winners · IPL/WPL 2026 · National Sports Awards · Dakar Youth Olympics.

1. MASTER CALENDAR — 2026 at one glance

Month	Event	Host / Venue	Winner / India angle
Jan	6th Khelo India Winter Games (20–26 Jan)	Leh (Ladakh) & Gulmarg (J&K)	Mascot **Sheen-E-She** (snow leopard); **figure skating** debuted
Jan	2nd Khelo India Beach Games	Ghoghla Beach, **Diu**	**Karnataka** overall champion; mascot **Pearl** (dolphin)
Jan	**Yonex-Sunrise India Open** (13–18 Jan, Super 750)	New Delhi	**Lin Chun-yi** (TPE) & **An Se-young** (KOR)
Jan	21st **Tata Mumbai Marathon** (18 Jan)	Mumbai	**Tadu Abate Deme** & **Yeshi Kalayu Chekole** (both Ethiopia)
Jan	**ICC U-19 Men's World Cup** (15 Jan–6 Feb)	Zimbabwe & Namibia	★ **India (6th title)**, beat England by 100 runs
Jan	**Hockey India League 2025–26** finals	Ranchi / Bhubaneswar	Women: **SG Pipers** (10 Jan); Men: **Kalinga Lancers** (26 Jan)
Jan	Padma Awards 2026 announced (25 Jan)	—	**Vijay Amritraj** (Tennis) Padma Bhushan; Rohit Sharma, Harmanpreet Kaur, Savita Punia (Padma Shri)
Jan	Saina Nehwal confirms **retirement**	—	2012 Olympic bronze, former World No. 1
Feb	**Australian Open** final (1 Feb)	Melbourne	**Carlos Alcaraz** (Career Grand Slam) & **Elena Rybakina**
Feb	**25th Winter Olympics** (6–22 Feb)	Milano-Cortina, Italy	**Norway** 18 gold/41 medals; India 0 medals (2 athletes)
Feb	**WPL 2026** final (5 Feb, 4th edition)	Vadodara	★ **RCB** beat Delhi Capitals by 6 wickets (2nd title)
Feb	**Men's T20 World Cup** begins (7 Feb)	India & Sri Lanka	20 teams, 55 matches
Mar	**Men's T20 World Cup** final (8 Mar)	Narendra Modi Stadium, Ahmedabad	★ **India** beat New Zealand by **96 runs** — 3rd title
Mar	**Winter Paralympics** (6–15 Mar)	Milano-Cortina	**China** top: 15 gold / 44 medals
Mar	**AFC Women's Asian Cup** final (21 Mar)	Sydney, Australia	★ **Japan** 1–0 Australia (3rd title)
Apr	**FIDE Candidates 2026**	Cyprus	**Javokhir Sindarov** (Uzbekistan), unbeaten
Apr	Thomas & Uber Cup Finals begin (24 Apr)	Forum Horsens, Denmark	see May
May	**Thomas Cup** (3 May)	Horsens	★ **China (12th)** bt France 3–1; **India joint bronze**
May	**Uber Cup** (3 May)	Horsens	★ **South Korea (3rd)** bt China 3–1
May	**IPL 2026** final (31 May)	Ahmedabad	★ **RCB** bt Gujarat Titans by 5 wickets (back-to-back)

Month	Event	Host / Venue	Winner / India angle
May	**French Open** (24 May–7 Jun)	Roland Garros, Paris	**Alexander Zverev** & **Mirra Andreeva**
May	**UEFA Champions League** final (30 May)	Puskás Aréna, Budapest	★ **PSG** bt Arsenal 1–1 (4–3 pens)
Jun	**SAFF Women's Championship** final (6 Jun)	Fatorda, Goa	★ **India** 3–1 Bangladesh — record **6th** title
Jun	**Norway Chess**	Oslo	**R Praggnanandhaa** — first Indian champion
Jun	**FIFA World Cup** begins (11 Jun)	USA / Canada / Mexico	48 teams, 104 matches, 12 groups of 4
Jun	**ICC Women's T20 World Cup** (12 Jun–5 Jul)	England & Wales	12 teams, 7 venues
Jun	**Wimbledon** begins (29 Jun)	All England Club, London	see July
Jul	**Women's T20 WC** final (5 Jul)	Lord's, London	★ **Australia** bt England by 7 wickets — **7th** title
Jul	**Wimbledon** (29 Jun–12 Jul)	London	**Jannik Sinner** & **Linda Nosková**
Jul	**FIFA World Cup** final (19 Jul)	MetLife Stadium, New Jersey	★ **Spain** 1–0 Argentina (a.e.t.), Ferran Torres 106′
Jul	**CWG 2026** begins (23 Jul)	Glasgow, Scotland	23rd edition, 10 sports, mascot **Finnie**
Jul	**ICC Hall of Fame** (8 Jul)	—	**Sourav Ganguly**, 12th Indian
Aug	**CWG 2026** ends (2 Aug)	Glasgow	Australia 1st; **India 4th — 39 medals (13G 17S 9B)**
Aug	**National Sports Awards 2025** announced (18 Aug)	—	**No Khel Ratna**; 17 Arjuna, 5 Dronacharya
Aug	**FIH Hockey World Cup** (15–30 Aug)	Wavre (BEL) & Amstelveen (NED)	Men ★ **Germany**; Women ★ **Argentina**
Aug	**BWF World Championships** (17–23 Aug)	**New Delhi**	Alex Lanier, An Se-young; Treesa–Gayatri **bronze**
Sep	**US Open** finals (12–13 Sep)	Flushing Meadows, New York	**Zverev** & **Rybakina**
Sep	**46th Chess Olympiad** (ends 27 Sep)	Samarkand, Uzbekistan	Uzbekistan Open gold; India **silver** + Gaprindashvili Cup
Sep	**20th Asian Games** begins (19 Sep)	Aichi-Nagoya, Japan	Mascot **HONOHON**; motto Imagine One Asia
Oct	**Asian Games** ends (4 Oct)	Aichi-Nagoya	China 1st; **India 4th — 85 medals (21G 27S 37B)**; Doha 2030 next
Oct	India women's captain changed (6 Oct)	—	**Smriti Mandhana** replaces Harmanpreet Kaur
Oct	**5th Asian Para Games** (19–24 Oct)	Aichi-Nagoya	**India 4th — record 114 medals (30G 35S 49B)**
Oct	Pankaj Advani (23 Oct)	Great Wyrley, England	**29th world billiards title**
Oct	**Ballon d'Or 2026** (26 Oct)	London Palladium	**Harry Kane** (Alexia Putellas, women's)
Oct	**World Wrestling Championships** (30 Oct)	Astana, Kazakhstan	**Manisha Bhanwala** — India's 1st woman world champion
Oct	**Dakar 2026 YOG** opens (31 Oct)	Senegal	First Olympic event in Africa
Nov	**F1 2026 champion** (1 Nov)	Mexico City GP	**Kimi Antonelli** — youngest-ever F1 champion
Nov	**Dakar 2026** first India medal (2 Nov)	Dakar	BRONZE **Dhinidhi Desinghu** — India's 1st-ever Olympic swimming medal
UPCOMING: Nov	World Chess Championship (25 Nov–15 Dec)	**Geneva**	Gukesh vs Sindarov — youngest title match ever

2. MONTH-WISE NOTES + MNEMONICS

JANUARY 2026

Fact	Exam hook
6th Khelo India Winter Games, 20–26 Jan, inaugurated at **NDS Stadium, Leh** by LG Kavinder Gupta; second leg at **Gulmarg (J&K)**	**Leh = ice** (ice hockey, speed skating, figure skating); **Gulmarg = snow** (alpine/nordic skiing, snowboarding, ski mountaineering)
Mascot **Sheen-E-She ("Shan")**, the snow leopard; theme Nurturing Winter Sports Excellence; **figure skating included for the first time**	Snow leopard = Ladakh's state animal

Fact	Exam hook
2nd Khelo India Beach Games, Ghoghla Beach, **Diu**; mascot **Pearl** (dolphin); **Karnataka** champion	"Beach = Diu, Pearl = dolphin"
India Open 2026 (Super 750, 13–18 Jan, Indira Gandhi Indoor Stadium): MS **Lin Chun-yi** (Chinese Taipei, maiden Super 750), WS **An Se-young** (KOR, defended), MD Liang Weikeng/Wang Chang (CHN), WD Liu Shengshu/Tan Ning (CHN), XD Dechapol/Supissara (THA)	5 finals: TPE–KOR–CHN–CHN–THA
Mumbai Marathon 2026 (21st, 18 Jan): **Tadu Abate Deme** (2:09:55) & **Yeshi Kalayu Chekole** (2:25:13), both Ethiopia; Indian elite **Kartik Karkera** & **Sanjivani Jadhav**	Ethiopian double
U-19 WC 2026 (16th, 15 Jan–6 Feb, Zimbabwe + Namibia): **India's record 6th title**, beat England by **100 runs** at Harare Sports Club; India 411/9 (highest U-19 final total); **Vaibhav Sooryavanshi 175 off 80**, 30 sixes (tournament record), 55-ball century, Player of Match + Player of Tournament; captain Ayush Mhatre	6th title = India leads (Australia 4, Pakistan 2)
Australian Open (finals 1 Feb): **Alcaraz** beat Djokovic 2–6, 6–2, 6–3, 7–5 → **Career Grand Slam**, youngest man to complete it (22y 272d), 7th major; **Rybakina** beat Sabalenka 6–4, 4–6, 6–4 → 2nd major	Alcaraz's first AO title
HIL 2025–26: Women — **SG Pipers** beat Shrachi/Rarh Bengal Tigers on shootout (10 Jan, maiden title); Men — **Kalinga Lancers** beat Ranchi Royals 3–2 (26 Jan, 2nd title)	Kalinga = men, SG Pipers = women
Padma Awards 2026 (announced 25 Jan; 131 total: 5 Vibhushan, 13 Bhushan, 113 Shri): **Vijay Amritraj (tennis) — Padma Bhushan**; Padma Shri in sports include **Rohit Sharma, Harmanpreet Kaur, Savita Punia, Praveen Kumar**	Investiture (sports honorees) held 25 May
Saina Nehwal confirms retirement (19–20 Jan): London 2012 bronze, former World No. 1, last event Singapore Open 2023	First Indian badminton Olympic medallist
Vidarbha won its **first Vijay Hazare Trophy** (33rd edition, 2025–26); **MS Dhoni** named ambassador of **Bajaj Pune Grand Tour**, India's first international multi-stage professional road cycling race	"Firsts" are exam favourites
Pradhan Mantri Rashtriya Bal Puraskar 2026: 20 children, incl. cricketer **Vaibhav Sooryavanshi** (Sports)	Same boy dominates Jan + Feb + May + Oct 2026 news

MNEMONIC: **M1 — January "FIRSTS" chain:** "**K**helo **W**inter, **B**each **D**iu, **I**ndia **O**pen, **M**umbai **M**arathon, **U**-19, **P**adma, **S**aina" → **K-W-B-D-I-O-M-M-U-P-S**: KIWG → Beach Games (Diu) → India Open → Mumbai Marathon → U-19 WC → Padma → Saina.

FEBRUARY 2026

Fact	Exam hook
XXV Winter Olympics, Milano Cortina 2026, 6–22 Feb, Italy; opening at **San Siro (Milan)**, closing at **Verona Arena**; motto **"IT's Your Vibe"**; **ski mountaineering** new sport; ~90 nations	25th edition
Mascots: **Tina** (white stoat, **Olympics**, name from Cor**TINA**) & **Milo** (brown stoat, **Paralympics**, name from **MI**lano); six snowdrop friends "The Flo"	Designed by Italian schoolchildren
Final medal table: **Norway 18 gold / 41 total** (record), USA 2nd (12G/33), Netherlands 3rd, Italy (host) 4th; top-5 order: Norway, USA, Netherlands, Italy, Germany	Norway topped every Winter Games since 2014
India: **2 athletes, 0 medals**. **Arif Mohammad Khan** (flag bearer, opening) **39th in men's slalom** — India's best-ever Winter Olympics finish (previous 49th, Calgary 1988); **Stanzin Lundup** (Ladakh, closing flag bearer) 104th in men's 10 km freestyle cross-country	"39 & 104"
WPL 2026 (4th edition), final 5 Feb, Kotambi Stadium **Vadodara**: **RCB 204/4 beat DC 203/4 by 6 wickets** — highest successful chase in WPL history; **Smriti Mandhana 87 (41)** + Georgia Voll 79 (165-run stand); Mandhana **Orange Cap 377 runs** & Player of the Match (final); **Sophie Devine** = Player of the Tournament **and Purple Cap (17 wickets)**; Nandni Sharma Emerging Player; DC's **4th consecutive final defeat**; RCB's **2nd title** (after 2024)	377 / 17
Men's **T20 World Cup 2026** began 7 Feb (10th edition, **India & Sri Lanka**, 20 teams, 55 matches, 8 venues)	Final on 8 Mar

MNEMONIC: **M2 — Winter mascots:** "**Tina ← Cor**TINA, **Milo ← MI**lano" — the names hide the two host cities. **T**ina = **T**op (Olympics, white/winter); **M**ilo = **M**issing a paw (Paralympics, brown/summer). MNEMONIC: **M3 — India at Milano Cortina:** "**Do** athletes, **Zero** medals, **39** & **104**" → "**2-0-39-104**".

MARCH 2026

Fact	Exam hook
ICC Men's T20 World Cup 2026 final, 8 Mar, **Narendra Modi Stadium, Ahmedabad**: **India 255/5 beat New Zealand 159 all out by 96 runs**. India's **3rd title** (2007, 2024, 2026) — first team to **win 3**, first to **defend** the title, first to win it **on home soil**; captain **Suryakumar Yadav**, coach **Gautam Gambhir**	96 runs = biggest final margin
Sanju Samson — Player of the Tournament (321 runs, avg 80.25, SR 199.37, only 5 innings; highest Indian single-edition tally, past Virat Kohli's 319 in 2014), **89 off 46 in the final**; **Jasprit Bumrah 4/15 = Player of the Final**; **Sahibzada Farhan (PAK) 383 runs** = most runs in the edition	321 / 383 / 96
Semi-finals: NZ bt SA by 9 wickets (Kolkata, 4 Mar); India bt England by 7 runs (Mumbai, 5 Mar)	—
XIV Winter Paralympics, 6–15 Mar, Milano-Cortina: **79 medal events, 6 sports, 55 nations, 611 athletes**; **China topped with 15 gold / 44 total**; USA 2nd, Russia 3rd; host Italy's best-ever (16); **wheelchair curling mixed doubles debuted**; 50th anniversary of first Winter Paralympics	China ≠ Norway (Olympics)
AFC Women's Asian Cup 2026 (Australia), final 21 Mar at Stadium Australia, Sydney: **Japan 1–0 Australia** (Maika Hamano 17′), Japan's **3rd** title (2014, 2018, 2026); record crowd **74,357**; **Riko Ueki** top scorer (6), **Alanna Kennedy** MVP, **Ayaka Yamashita** best GK	Japan beat Australia in all 3 of their final wins

MNEMONIC: **M4 — T20 WC 2026:** "**I**ndia **96** **N**ew **Z**ealand, **3** in '**26**, **S**anju **321**" → "**IN-96-NZ-3-S321**". Hindi-friendly: "**chhah-nabbe (96) se teesri baar, Sanju ne 321**".

APRIL 2026

Fact	Exam hook
FIDE Candidates Tournament 2026 (8 players, Cap St Georges, Cyprus): **Javokhir Sindarov (Uzbekistan)** won unbeaten with **9.5/13**, a round to spare; 6 wins + 7 draws; €700,000 prize pool	Earned right to challenge **D Gukesh**
Thomas & Uber Cup Finals 2026 began **24 April** at **Forum Horsens, Denmark** (34th Thomas, 31st Uber; 16 nations each)	Finals on 3 May

MNEMONIC: **M5 — Chess 2026 chain:** "**S**indarov (Candidates, Apr) → **P**ragg (Norway, Jun) → **U**zbek (Olympiad, Sep) → **G**ukesh (Geneva, Nov)" = "**SPUG**" → "**S**habad **P**ragg **U**zbek **G**ukesh". Note the **Uzbek triple**: Uzbek Candidates winner + Uzbek Olympiad host & Open gold + Uzbek challenger for the world title.

MAY 2026

Fact	Exam hook
Thomas Cup 2026 (3 May, Horsens): **China 3–1 France** → China's **12th** title, France's best-ever; **India joint bronze** (with Denmark) — India's first Thomas Cup podium in decades	**Uber Cup 2026**: **South Korea 3–1 China** → Korea's **3rd** title (2010, 2022, 2026); An Se-young led the way
IPL 2026 final, 31 May, Narendra Modi Stadium **Ahmedabad**: **RCB 161/5 (18 ov) beat Gujarat Titans 155/8 by 5 wickets** — **back-to-back titles** (RCB's 2nd); **Virat Kohli 75* (42)** Player of the Match; **Orange Cap: Vaibhav Sooryavanshi 776 runs** (RR, record); **Purple Cap: Kagiso Rabada 29 wickets** (GT); Player of the Series Sooryavanshi	776 / 29 / 5 wickets
French Open 2026 (125th, 24 May–7 Jun, clay): **Alexander Zverev** bt Flavio Cobolli 6–1, 4–6, 6–4, 6–7(5-7), 6–1 → **first major**, first German man to win a Slam since Boris Becker (1996); **Mirra Andreeva (19)** bt qualifier Maja Chwalińska 6–3, 6–2 → **first major**, youngest RG women's champion since Seles (1992); Alcaraz withdrew (wrist), Gauff lost in R3	Two first-time Slam champions
UEFA Champions League final 2026 (71st), 30 May, **Puskás Aréna, Budapest** — first UCL final in Hungary: **PSG 1–1 Arsenal (a.e.t.), PSG won 4–3 on penalties** (Havertz 6′, Dembélé 65′ pen); PSG retained the trophy under **Luis Enrique**	Back-to-back UCL champions (2025, 2026)
Padma Awards 2026 investiture: 9 sports icons honoured at Rashtrapati Bhavan (25 May)	Announced in Jan, conferred in May

MNEMONIC: **M6 — Thomas/Uber/Worlds badminton:** "**C-K-D**": **C**hina takes **Thomas**, **K**orea takes **Uber**, **D**elhi hosts the **Worlds**. Hindi: "**C**heen Thomas, **K**orea Uber, **D**illi Worlds".

JUNE 2026

Fact	Exam hook
SAFF Women's Championship 2026 (8th edition, hosted by India): final **6 Jun, Fatorda Stadium, Margao, Goa** — **India 3–1 Bangladesh**, **record 6th title**, first since 2019; won all 4 matches, 18 goals scored / 1 conceded; coach **Crispin Chettri**; Aveka Singh top scorer (4), Sanfida Nongrum MVP, Panthoi Chanu best GK	6th title, 7-year wait

Fact	Exam hook
Norway Chess 2026 (Oslo): **R Praggnanandhaa** became **first Indian** to win the title (18 points; beat Vincent Keymer in final round; beat Magnus Carlsen **twice** in classical games; came back from last place with 4 straight wins)	Pragg ≠ Gukesh
FIFA World Cup 2026 (23rd) kicked off **11 June**: **USA + Canada + Mexico**, first 3-host WC, **48 teams, 12 groups of 4, 104 matches (72 group + 32 knockout), 16 venues**; mascots **Maple** (moose, Canada, GK #1), **Zayu** (jaguar, Mexico, striker #9), **Clutch** (bald eagle, USA, midfielder #10) — first triple-mascot WC	48/104/12/16
ICC Women's T20 World Cup 2026 (10th), 12 Jun–5 Jul, **England & Wales**, expanded to **12 teams**, 7 venues	Final at Lord's
Wimbledon 2026 (139th) began 29 Jun (grass, All England Club); record prize pot **£64.2 million**, £3.6m per singles champion	—
Other June one-liners: **Satwiksairaj Rankireddy–Chirag Shetty** won the **Singapore Open Super 750** (first Indian MD pair to win it); **Lionel Messi** became the first footballer to receive the **Princess of Asturias Award for Sports 2026**; **Cristiano Ronaldo** became the first player to score in **six** FIFA World Cups; **Smriti Mandhana** named in TIME's 100 Most Influential People in Sports 2026; India topped the **ISSF Junior World Championship** (Suhl, Germany) medal tally	"Firsts" cluster

MNEMONIC: **M7 — FIFA hosts:** "**U Can Mix**" = **U**SA + **Can**ada + **Mex**ico. MNEMONIC: **M8 — World Cup maths:** "**12 × 4 = 48** teams; **72 + 32 = 104** matches" → remember **12-4-48-72-32-104**. MNEMONIC: **M9 — FIFA mascots:** "**M-Z-C = 1-9-10**": **M**aple (Canada, moose, goalkeeper #1), **Z**ayu (Mexico, jaguar, striker #9), **C**lutch (USA, bald eagle, midfielder #10) — first WC with **three** mascots.

JULY 2026

Fact	Exam hook
ICC Women's T20 World Cup 2026 final, 5 Jul, **Lord's**: **Australia 153/3 (17.1 ov) beat England 150/4 by 7 wickets** — **7th T20 title / 14th women's World Cup overall**, unbeaten tournament, highest successful chase in a WT20 WC final; **Beth Mooney 64 (49)** Player of Match + Player of Series (her 3rd fifty in a T20 WC final); Phoebe Litchfield 48; Nat Sciver-Brunt 58*	Australia ≠ India (men's WC)
Wimbledon 2026 (29 Jun–12 Jul): **Jannik Sinner** bt Alexander Zverev 6–7(7-9), 7–6(7-2), 6–3, 6–4 → defended title, **5th major**; **Linda Nosková** bt Karolína Muchová 6–2, 5–7, 6–3 → **maiden major**, 21y 236d (youngest Wimbledon champion since Kvitová 2011), **first all-Czech Wimbledon final**	Sinner 5 Slams
FIFA World Cup 2026 final, **19 Jul, MetLife / New York New Jersey Stadium, East Rutherford**: **Spain 1–0 Argentina (a.e.t.)**, **Ferran Torres 106′** — Spain's **2nd** title (first since 2010), only **1 goal conceded** in the tournament, first nation to hold men's + women's WC simultaneously; **England 3rd** (6–4 France), France 4th	1–0, 106′, 2nd title
FIFA individual awards: **Golden Ball – Rodri** (ESP), **Golden Boot – Kylian Mbappé** (FRA, **10 goals**, first to win it twice), **Golden Glove – Unai Simón** (ESP), **Best Young Player – Pau Cubarsí** (ESP), **Fair Play – Netherlands**; Silver Ball Messi, Bronze Ball Mbappé	Spain swept 3 of 5
Commonwealth Games 2026 opened **23 July**, Glasgow (23rd edition, **10 sports**, 74 nations, ~3,000 athletes, OVO Hydro opening); flag-bearer **Mirabai Chanu**, baton-bearer **Lovlina Borgohain**, closing flag-bearer **Jaismine Lamboria**; mascot **Finnie** the unicorn	Glasgow hosted 2nd time (after 2014)
ICC Hall of Fame (8 Jul): **Sourav Ganguly** inducted — **12th Indian** (113 Tests, 308 ODIs; 2003 WC final, 2002 Champions Trophy shared)	"Dada"

MNEMONIC: **M10 — FIFA awards:** "**R**un **M**ore, **U**se **C**ool **N**erves" = **R**odri (Golden Ball) → **M**bappé (Golden Boot) → **U**nai Simón (Glove) → **C**ubarsí (Young) → **N**etherlands (Fair Play). MNEMONIC: **M11 — CWG dates:** "**23-23-2**" → **23rd** edition, began **23** July, ended **2** August.

AUGUST 2026

Fact	Exam hook
CWG 2026 final table (2 Aug): **Australia 1st** (70G/45S/56B = 171), England 2nd, Canada 3rd, **India 4th with 39 medals — 13 gold, 17 silver, 9 bronze**; Scotland 5th (also 39, 13 gold) — India ranked higher on **silver count (17 vs 9)**	13+17+9 = 39
Mirabai Chanu won India's **first gold** (women's 48 kg weightlifting, 190 kg total = 85 snatch + 105 C&J, Games records) — **hat-trick of CWG golds** (2018, 2022, 2026), 4th CWG medal overall (2014 silver)	2nd Indian after Vinesh Phogat to win 3 consecutive CWG golds
Boxing = 10 medals (7 gold, 3 silver) — highest boxing gold tally by any nation at a single CWG: Sakshi Chaudhary, Preeti Pawar, Jaismine Lamboria, Priya Ghanghas, Arundhati Choudhary, Sachin Siwach, Ankush Panghal; silvers Jadumani Singh, Lovlina Borgohain, Narender Berwal	7 golds
First-ever **judo golds**: **Asmita Dey** (W 48 kg) & **Harsh Singh** (M 60 kg); para-athletics golds Sharmila Dhankar, Dilip Gavit, Soman Rana; best-ever para campaign (7 medals); **Neeraj Chopra silver** in javelin; 122-athlete contingent across 10 sports	Reduced programme (no wrestling, shooting, badminton, hockey, TT, squash)

Fact	Exam hook
National Sports Awards 2025 (announced **18 Aug 2026**, delayed): **NO Major Dhyan Chand Khel Ratna** (first such gap since 2014; first time "no sportsperson considered"); **17 Arjuna Awards** — Tejaswin Shankar, Muhammed Ajmal V, Priyanka Goswami (athletics), Treesa Jolly, Gayatri Gopichand (badminton), Narender (boxing), **Vidit Gujrathi, Divya Deshmukh** (chess), Dhanush Srikanth (deaf shooting), Lalremsiami, Rajkumar Pal (hockey), Surjeet, Pooja (kabaddi), Rudransh Khandelwal (para shooting), Ekta Bhyan (para athletics), Arvind Singh (rowing), Akhil Sheoran (shooting); **Arjuna (Lifetime): I. Arumainayagam** (1962 Asiad football gold); **5 Dronacharya** (Parveer Singh, Chhote Lal Yadav, Neha Nandkumar Chavan + Lifetime Dharmendra Singh Yadav, Virender Kumar); **Rashtriya Khel Protsahan Puraskar: Army Paralympic Node, Pune**; panel headed by Justice (Retd.) **Arun Kumar Mishra**	Award year ≠ announcement year
FIH Hockey World Cup 2026 (15–30 Aug, joint finals in **Wavre, Belgium & Amstelveen, Netherlands**, 16 teams each): **Men — Germany 1–0 Spain** (30 Aug) → **4th title, 2nd in a row**, equalled Pakistan's record; bronze Argentina; **India 8th**. **Women — Argentina bt Netherlands 1–1 (3–1 shootout)** (29 Aug) → first world title since 2010, ended Dutch 4-in-a-row bid	Germany = men, Argentina = women
BWF World Championships 2026 (30th, 17–23 Aug, **Indira Gandhi Indoor Stadium, New Delhi** — India hosted for the 2nd time after **Hyderabad 2009**): MS **Alex Lanier** (FRA, first French world singles champion) bt Kodai Naraoka; WS **An Se-young** (KOR, 2nd world title) bt Akane Yamaguchi; MD Liang Weikeng/Wang Chang (CHN); WD Baek Ha-na/Lee So-hee (KOR); XD Thom Gicquel/Delphine Delrue (FRA) — **France won 2 golds**; **Treesa Jolly / Gayatri Gopichand bronze in WD** — India's **first women's doubles Worlds medal since 2011** (Jwala/Ashwini), India's **16th Worlds medal** and a medal in every edition since 2011	Delhi = 2nd hosting

MNEMONIC: **M12 — India's 2026 medal tallies:** "**teen-nau (39) → pachaasi (85) → ek sau chaudah (114)**" = **CWG 39 → Asian Games 85 → Asian Para Games 114**. And "**teenon mein chautha**" — India finished **4th in all three** (CWG, Asiad, Para Asiad). MNEMONIC: **M13 — "khaali khel, sattarah Arjuna"**: **No Khel Ratna**, **17 Arjuna** in the awards announced on 18 Aug 2026. MNEMONIC: **M14 — Hockey:** "**G-A / I-I**" = World Cup **G**ermany (men) + **A**rgentina (women); Asian Games **I**ndia (men) + **I**ndia (women).

SEPTEMBER 2026

Fact	Exam hook
US Open 2026 (24 Aug–13 Sep, Flushing Meadows): **Alexander Zverev** bt **Ben Shelton** 6–3, 7–6(7-2), 5–7, 6–2 (13 Sep) → **2nd Slam of 2026**, 1st US Open; **Elena Rybakina** bt Aryna Sabalenka 6–4, 5–7, 6–2 (12 Sep) → **3rd Slam**, 1st US Open, **new World No. 1**, both hard-court Slams in one season; record **$5.5 million** each	Zverev & Rybakina = 2 Slams each in 2026
46th FIDE Chess Olympiad (Samarkand, Uzbekistan; ended 27 Sep): **Open — Uzbekistan gold, India silver, Germany bronze** (India & Germany tied on 18 points; India won on head-to-head); **Women — China gold, Kazakhstan silver, India bronze**; India retained the **Nona Gaprindashvili Cup** (best overall nation) for a **3rd straight** edition (2022, 2024, 2026)	India = only nation on both podiums
20th Asian Games opened **19 Sep, Aichi-Nagoya, Japan** (45 NOCs + OCA Refugee Team; 43 sports / 71 disciplines / 469 events); motto **"Imagine One Asia"**; mascot **HONOHON** (from Japanese honoho = flame; Shachihoko-inspired ears, Kabuki kumadori eyes); emblem: purple (Aichi's iris), gold (Kinshachi of Nagoya Castle), green (environment), red sun (OCA)	20th edition in '26
Other Sept one-liners: **Yashaswini Ghorpade & Harmeet Desai** won a mixed-doubles medal at the **29th ITTF-ATTU Asian Championships, Tashkent**; India's women's hockey team won a **3rd consecutive AHF Junior Asia Cup** while the men won their **6th** continental crown	—

MNEMONIC: **M15 — Grand Slam men:** "**A**ll **Z**ebras **S**ip **Z**am-Zam" = **A**lcaraz (AO) → **Z**verev (RG) → **S**inner (Wimbledon) → **Z**verev (USO). MNEMONIC: **M16 — Grand Slam women:** "**R**ani **A**ayi, **N**eena **R**epeat" = **R**ybakina (AO) → **A**ndreeva (RG) → **N**osková (Wimbledon) → **R**ybakina (USO). Note the **repeat** of Zverev and Rybakina.

OCTOBER 2026

Fact	Exam hook
20th Asian Games ends 4 Oct: **China 169 gold / 341 total**, Japan 2nd (83G/269), South Korea 3rd (39G/150); **India 4th — 85 medals (21 gold, 27 silver, 37 bronze)**, ahead of Uzbekistan (also 21 gold) on **silvers**; India's **2nd-best Asiad haul ever** (record: Hangzhou 2023, 28 gold)	21+27+37 = 85
India's first gold: **women's T20 cricket** — beat **Sri Lanka by 147 runs** (India 216/3); **men's cricket** beat **Pakistan by 19 runs** → cricket double; **hockey double** (women's first gold **since 1982**, men's 2nd consecutive); **kabaddi double**	"**CHK × 2**" (Cricket, Hockey, Kabaddi — both men & women)

Fact	Exam hook
Sport-wise: **athletics 24 medals** (most), **shooting 15**, **archery 9 with 5 golds** (most golds); gold medallists include **Lovlina Borgohain** (boxing, 2nd Indian woman after Mary Kom to win Asiad boxing gold), **Kumkum Mohod** (first Indian woman individual recurve gold), **Pranavi Urs** (first Indian woman golf gold), **Neeru Dhanda** (women's trap), **Sujeet Kalkal / Aman Sehrawat** (wrestling); **Vithya Ramraj 54.75 s** broke **P.T. Usha's 42-year-old 400 m hurdles national record**; **Vaibhav Sooryavanshi** = youngest Indian Asiad gold medallist	Sawan Barwal = first men's marathon Asiad medal since 1982
OCA flag handover (4 Oct): **Doha 2030** will host the next Asian Games (Qatar's 2nd time, after 2006); slogan **"The Games We Live For"**	2030 ≠ 2026
6 Oct: **Smriti Mandhana** appointed India women's captain **across formats** after **Harmanpreet Kaur** stepped down; Mandhana also became the **leading run-scorer in women's international cricket** (passed Mithali Raj) and has 18 centuries	Captaincy change = classic exam Q
5th Asian Para Games (19–24 Oct, Aichi-Nagoya): **India 4th, record 114 medals — 30 gold, 35 silver, 49 bronze** (previous best 108 in Hangzhou 2023); **168 athletes** across 11 sports; para athletics **65 medals**; **Sandeep** set a **world record (52.28 s in 400 m T64)** for India's **100th medal**; Sumit Antil javelin gold; Sheetal Devi & Toman Kumar compound mixed-team archery gold; Nitesh Kumar & Naveen badminton golds; 9 golds on the final day	30+35+49 = 114
23 Oct: **Pankaj Advani** won his **29th world title** (WBL World Billiards Championship, Great Wyrley, England) beating Robert Hall **1,906–1,206** with a **587 break**; 21st world billiards title	29 world titles
26 Oct: **70th Ballon d'Or** at the **London Palladium** (first UK ceremony): **Harry Kane** (Bayern Munich / England) — first English winner since **Michael Owen (2001)**, 5th Englishman, 73 goals in 65 games, also Gerd Müller Trophy; Mbappé 2nd, Lamine Yamal 3rd; **Alexia Putellas** won the women's award for a **3rd** time	Kane ≠ a World Cup winner
30 Oct: **Manisha Bhanwala** became **India's first woman world wrestling champion** (59 kg, Astana, Kazakhstan), beat Abigail Nette **8–6** after trailing 0–6; only 2nd Indian world wrestling gold after **Sushil Kumar (2010)**; India won 4 medals (also silvers Neelam Sirohi, Kajal Dhochak; bronze Tanu Sharma)	First-ever senior worlds gold for Indian women
31 Oct: **Dakar 2026 Summer Youth Olympic Games** opened (see November)	First Olympic event in Africa
Other Oct one-liners: **ICC Players of the Month (Sept 2026, announced 13 Oct)** — **Shubman Gill** (record 5th men's award) & **Shafali Verma** (2nd); **PV Sindhu** runner-up at the **French Open 2026** badminton (An Se-young's 4th French Open title); IOA instituted new awards for Asiad gold medallists, first recipients **Kumkum Mohod** & **Sujeet Kalkal**	—

MNEMONIC: **M17 — Asian Games:** "**20th in '26**" (20th edition in 2026) + "**CHK × 2**" = **C**ricket, **H**ockey, **K**abaddi — **both** men's and women's golds. Hindi: "**CHK — do-do gold**". MNEMONIC: **M18 — Para Games:** "**5 → 114 → 4**": **5th** edition, **114** medals, **4th** place. Bonus trap: Para Games (114) exceeded Asian Games (85) by **29** medals. MNEMONIC: **M19 — Mascot ladder:** "**T**ina→**F**innie→**H**onohon" = "**T**o **F**ind **H**onours": **T**ina & Milo (Winter Olympics), **F**innie (CWG), **H**onohon (Asian Games). Add **Sheen-E-She** (Khelo India Winter) and **Maple–Zayu–Clutch** (FIFA WC) as separate.

NOVEMBER 2026 (1–3 Nov; events in progress)

Fact	Exam hook
1 Nov — Formula 1: **Kimi Antonelli (Mercedes, Italy)** became the **youngest-ever F1 World Champion** (20 years 68 days, beating Sebastian Vettel's 2010 record by ~3 years), clinching with **P3 at the Mexico City GP** (Max Verstappen won, Lewis Hamilton 2nd); 380 points, 9 wins, 16 podiums; first Italian champion since Alberto Ascari (1953)	2026 F1 biggest rule reset: ~**50:50** ICE/electric power, **MGU-H removed**, **active aero replaces DRS**, **100% sustainable fuel**; **Cadillac** joined as the **11th** team (Bottas/Pérez), **Audi** replaced Sauber, **Madrid GP** debuted at the Madring
2 Nov — Dakar 2026: **Dhinidhi Desinghu (16, Bengaluru)** won **bronze in women's 100 m freestyle (56.27 s)** — **India's first medal at Dakar 2026** and **India's first-ever swimming medal at ANY Olympic event (senior or youth)**; also lowered her own national mark (56.57 s); she was India's youngest Olympian at **Paris 2024** (age 14)	Gold Ana Bobanovic (CRO, 55.89), silver Alyssa Lawson (NZL, 56.13)
Dakar 2026 (31 Oct–13 Nov, **4th Summer YOG**): Senegal — **Dakar, Diamniadio, Saly**; **first IOC/Olympic event on African soil**; slogan **"Africa welcomes, Dakar celebrates"**; ~**2,663 athletes** (1,336 boys, 1,327 girls), **205 NOCs + Refugee Olympic Team**, **25 sports**, 8 venues; originally due 2022, postponed 4 years due to COVID-19 (last edition Buenos Aires 2018); **17 athletes (11 women, 6 men) in 11 sports** — India's smallest YOG contingent; names to watch: Syndrela Das (TT), Tanvi Patri (badminton), Dhinidhi Desinghu (swimming), Shourya Ambure (athletics); IOA president **P.T. Usha**	"4th YOG, 1st Africa"

Fact	Exam hook
UPCOMING — do NOT treat as a result: **FIDE World Championship 2026**, **Gukesh (IND) vs Sindarov (UZB)**, **Geneva, 25 Nov–15 Dec 2026**, best of 14 games — youngest world title match ever (both 20); **IBSF World Snooker Championship, Indore, Nov 2026**; Dakar YOG closes 13 Nov; F1 season continues (Brazil etc.)	—

MNEMONIC: **M20 — DAKAR acrostic: D**elayed (2022→2026) · **A**frica's first Olympic event · **K**ids (U-17/18) · **A**pprox 2,700 athletes · **R**efugee Olympic Team. Dates: **31 Oct (Halloween) → 13 Nov**. MNEMONIC: **M21 — F1:** "**K for Kid**" — **K**imi is the **youngest** champion; title sealed on **1-11-26** (1 Nov 2026) in **Mexico**.

3. THEME-WISE SUPER TABLES (the real scoring zone)

3.1 Grand Slams 2026 — singles champions

Slam	Dates / Surface	Men's champion	Men's runner-up	Women's champion	Women's runner-up
Australian Open (Melbourne, hard)	Final 1 Feb	**Carlos Alcaraz** (ESP) — Career Slam, 7th major	Novak Djokovic	**Elena Rybakina** (KAZ) — 2nd major	Aryna Sabalenka
French Open (Paris, clay, 125th)	24 May–7 Jun	**Alexander Zverev** (GER) — 1st major	Flavio Cobolli	**Mirra Andreeva** (19) — 1st major	Maja Chwalińska (Q)
Wimbledon (London, grass, 139th)	29 Jun–12 Jul	**Jannik Sinner** (ITA) — 5th major, defended	Alexander Zverev	**Linda Nosková** (CZE) — 1st major	Karolína Muchová
US Open (New York, hard)	Finals 12–13 Sep	**Alexander Zverev** (GER) — 2nd Slam of 2026	Ben Shelton	**Elena Rybakina** (KAZ) — 3rd major, new No. 1	Aryna Sabalenka

MNEMONIC: M15/M16: Men **A-Z-S-Z** ("All Zebras Sip Zam-Zam"), Women **R-A-N-R** ("Rani Aayi, Neena Repeat"). **Zverev and Rybakina won two Slams each.**

3.2 Cricket 2026 — all five big trophies

Tournament	Edition / Dates	Host	Champion	Runner-up	Key numbers
U-19 Men's WC	16th, 15 Jan–6 Feb	Zimbabwe + Namibia	**★ India (6th)**	England	Won by **100 runs**; Sooryavanshi 175 (80), 30 sixes
WPL	4th, final 5 Feb	Vadodara	**★ RCB (2nd)**	Delhi Capitals	Won by **6 wickets**, chased 204; Mandhana 377 runs (Orange Cap)
Men's T20 WC	10th, 7 Feb–8 Mar	India + Sri Lanka	**★ India (3rd)**	New Zealand	Won by **96 runs**; Samson 321 runs (POTT)
IPL	final 31 May	Ahmedabad	**★ RCB (back-to-back)**	Gujarat Titans	Won by **5 wickets**; Sooryavanshi 776 (Orange), Rabada 29 (Purple)
Women's T20 WC	10th, 12 Jun–5 Jul	England + Wales	**★ Australia (7th)**	England	Won by **7 wickets**; Mooney 64 & POTT

MNEMONIC: M22 — "I-R-I-R-A" = "**I** Read **I** Read **A**gain": **I**ndia (U-19) → **R**CB (WPL) → **I**ndia (T20 WC) → **R**CB (IPL) → **A**ustralia (Women's T20 WC). Note: **India won the men's T20 WC, Australia the women's**. RCB did the **WPL + IPL double** (captains: Mandhana / Rajat Patidar).

3.3 Football 2026

Event	Winner	Runner-up / detail
AFC Women's Asian Cup (21 Mar, Sydney)	**Japan (3rd)**	Australia 0–1; Hamano 17′; crowd 74,357
UEFA Champions League (30 May, Budapest)	**PSG (2nd straight)**	Arsenal 1–1, 4–3 pens
FIFA World Cup (11 Jun–19 Jul, USA/CAN/MEX)	**Spain (2nd)**	Argentina 0–1 a.e.t.; Torres 106′; England 3rd
SAFF Women's Championship (6 Jun, Goa)	**India (6th)**	Bangladesh 1–3
Ballon d'Or 2026 (26 Oct, London)	**Harry Kane**	Mbappé 2nd, Yamal 3rd; Putellas (women)

MNEMONIC: M23 — "J-P-S-K" = "Jab PSG, Spain Kane": **J**apan (AFC Women's), **P**SG (UCL), **S**pain (WC), **K**ane (Ballon d'Or). India's own football crown: "**SAFF 6 → Goa → 3–1 Bangladesh**".

3.4 India's 2026 multi-sport report card

Games	Edition / Dates	Host	India's rank	India's medals	Top nation
Winter Olympics	25th, 6–22 Feb	Milano-Cortina, Italy	— (0 medals, 2 athletes)	**0**	Norway (18G/41)
Winter Paralympics	14th, 6–15 Mar	Milano-Cortina, Italy	—	—	China (15G/44)
Commonwealth Games	23rd, 23 Jul–2 Aug	Glasgow, Scotland	**4th**	**39 = 13G + 17S + 9B**	Australia (70G/171)
Asian Games	20th, 19 Sep–4 Oct	Aichi-Nagoya, Japan	**4th**	**85 = 21G + 27S + 37B**	China (169G/341)
Asian Para Games	5th, 19–24 Oct	Aichi-Nagoya, Japan	**4th**	**114 = 30G + 35S + 49B** (record)	China (435 total)
Youth Olympics	4th, 31 Oct–13 Nov ongoing	Dakar, Senegal	in progress	1 bronze by 3 Nov (Dhinidhi)	—

MNEMONIC: M12: "39 → 85 → 114" (teen-nau, pachaasi, ek sau chaudah) and **"teenon mein chautha"** — 4th in CWG, Asiad and Para Asiad.

3.5 Badminton 2026

Event	Winner(s)	India angle
India Open (Jan, New Delhi)	Lin Chun-yi / An Se-young	Satwik–Chirag exited early
Thomas Cup (3 May, Horsens)	**China (12th)** bt France 3–1	**Joint bronze**
Uber Cup (3 May, Horsens)	**South Korea (3rd)** bt China 3–1	—
BWF Worlds (17–23 Aug, **New Delhi**)	Lanier (FRA), An Se-young (KOR), Liang/Wang (CHN), Baek/Lee (KOR), Gicquel/Delrue (FRA)	**Treesa Jolly / Gayatri Gopichand bronze**
Singapore Open (Super 750)	**Satwik–Chirag** (first Indian MD pair to win it)	—

MNEMONIC: M6: C-K-D — **C**hina (Thomas), **K**orea (Uber), **D**elhi (Worlds). **An Se-young 2026 treble:** India Open + Uber Cup + World Championships.

3.6 Hockey 2026

Event	Champion	Detail
HIL Men (26 Jan)	**Kalinga Lancers** (2nd)	bt Ranchi Royals 3–2
HIL Women (10 Jan)	**SG Pipers** (1st)	bt Bengal Tigers on shootout
Men's World Cup (30 Aug, Wavre)	**Germany (4th)**	bt Spain 1–0; equalled Pakistan's record; India 8th
Women's World Cup (29 Aug, Amstelveen)	**Argentina**	bt Netherlands 3–1 in shootout (1–1)
Asian Games (Oct)	**India men + India women**	Women's first Asiad hockey gold since 1982

MNEMONIC: M14: G-A / I-I.

3.7 Chess 2026

Event	Winner	Exam fact
Candidates (Apr, Cyprus)	**Javokhir Sindarov** (UZB)	Unbeaten 9.5/13, a round to spare
Norway Chess (Jun, Oslo)	**R Praggnanandhaa**	First Indian; beat Carlsen twice
46th Olympiad (Sep, Samarkand)	Open: **Uzbekistan** (India silver); Women: **China** (India bronze)	India retained **Nona Gaprindashvili Cup** 3rd straight time
UPCOMING: World Championship (25 Nov–15 Dec, Geneva)	Gukesh vs Sindarov	Youngest title match ever; both 20

MNEMONIC: M5: "SPUG" — **S**indarov, **P**ragg, **U**zbek, **G**ukesh.

3.8 Awards & honours 2026

Award	Recipient	What to remember
Padma Awards 2026 (announced 25 Jan)	**Vijay Amritraj — Padma Bhushan** (tennis); Rohit Sharma, Harmanpreet Kaur, Savita Punia, Praveen Kumar — Padma Shri	131 awards total: 5 / 13 / 113
National Sports Awards 2025 (announced **18 Aug 2026**)	**No Khel Ratna**; 17 Arjuna; **I. Arumainayagam** Arjuna (Lifetime); 5 Dronacharya; Army Paralympic Node, Pune (RKPP)	First Khel Ratna gap since 2014

Award	Recipient	What to remember
ICC Hall of Fame (8 Jul)	**Sourav Ganguly**	12th Indian
ICC Player of the Tournament (T20 WC)	**Sanju Samson**	321 runs, avg 80.25
ICC Players of the Month (Sept)	**Shubman Gill** (5th, record) & **Shafali Verma**	Announced 13 Oct
Ballon d'Or (26 Oct)	**Harry Kane** / **Alexia Putellas**	70th edition, first held in London
FIFA WC awards (19 Jul)	Rodri, Mbappé, Unai Simón, Cubarsí, Netherlands	M10
Princess of Asturias Sports 2026	**Lionel Messi**	First footballer to win it

MNEMONIC: M24 — Awards timeline: "**J**an **P**adma → **J**ul **H**all → **A**ug **A**rjuna → **O**ct **B**allon" = "**J-J-A-O**" ("**J**an Padma, **J**ul Hall, **A**ug Arjuna, **O**ct Ballon").

4. THE MNEMONIC BANK (M1 – M24, all in one place)

#	Mnemonic	Decodes to
M1	"**K**helo **W**inter, **B**each **D**iu, **I**ndia **O**pen, **M**umbai **M**arathon, **U**-19, **P**adma, **S**aina"	Jan: KIWG → Beach Games Diu → India Open → Mumbai Marathon → U-19 WC → Padma → Saina
M2	"**Tina ← CorTINA, Milo ← MI**lano"	Winter Olympics mascots & host cities (Tina = Olympics; Milo = Paralympics)
M3	"**2-0-39-104**"	India at Winter Olympics: 2 athletes, 0 medals, Arif Khan 39th, Lundup 104th
M4	"**IN-96-NZ-3-S321**"	T20 WC final: India 96 runs vs NZ, 3rd title, Samson 321
M5	"**SPUG**" / "Uzbek triple"	Chess: Sindarov, Pragg, Uzbek Olympiad, Gukesh
M6	"**C-K-D**"	Thomas→**C**hina, Uber→**K**orea, Worlds→**D**elhi
M7	"**U Can Mix**"	FIFA WC hosts: **U**SA + **Can**ada + **Mex**ico
M8	"**12×4=48; 72+32=104**"	WC 2026 format: 12 groups of 4 = 48 teams; 104 matches
M9	"**1-9-10**"	FIFA mascots: **Maple** (Canada, moose, GK #1), **Zayu** (Mexico, jaguar, striker #9), **Clutch** (USA, eagle, midfielder #10)
M10	"**R**un **M**ore, **U**se **C**ool **N**erves"	**R**odri, **M**bappé, **U**nai Simón, **C**ubarsí, **N**etherlands
M11	"**23-23-2**"	CWG: 23rd edition, 23 July start, 2 August end
M12	"**39 → 85 → 114**" / "teenon mein chautha"	India's CWG / Asiad / Para Asiad medals — all **4th** place
M13	"**khaali khel, sattarah Arjuna**"	No Khel Ratna, 17 Arjuna (18 Aug 2026)
M14	"**G-A / I-I**"	Hockey World Cup **G**ermany + **A**rgentina; Asiad **I**ndia + **I**ndia
M15	"**A**ll **Z**ebras **S**ip **Z**am-Zam"	Men's Slams: **A**lcaraz, **Z**verev, **S**inner, **Z**verev
M16	"**R**ani **A**ayi, **N**eena **R**epeat"	Women's Slams: **R**ybakina, **A**ndreeva, **N**osková, **R**ybakina
M17	"**20th in '26**" + "**CHK × 2**"	20th Asiad in 2026; **C**ricket-**H**ockey-**K**abaddi doubles
M18	"**5-114-4**"	5th Asian Para Games, 114 medals, 4th place
M19	"**T**o **F**ind **H**onours"	**T**ina (Winter), **F**innie (CWG), **H**onohon (Asiad) mascots
M20	"**DAKAR**"	**D**elayed 2022→26, **A**frica-first, **K**ids, **A**pprox 2,700, **R**efugee team
M21	"**K for Kid**"	**K**imi Antonelli = youngest F1 champion (1 Nov 2026)
M22	"**I-R-I-R-A**" = "I Read I Read Again"	Cricket: India, RCB, India, RCB, Australia
M23	"**J**ab **P**SG, **S**pain **K**ane"	Japan, PSG, Spain, Kane
M24	"**J-J-A-O**"	Jan Padma, Jul Hall of Fame, Aug Arjuna, Oct Ballon d'Or

How to make mnemonics stick: say each one aloud, write the decoded list from memory after 10 minutes, and again the next morning. Mnemonics without a decoding drill are useless — the MCQs below are your drill.

5. TRAP ALERTS (negative-marking zone)

#	Confusion	Correct fact
1	Men's T20 WC 2026 winner vs Women's T20 WC 2026 winner	**India** (men, 8 Mar) / **Australia** (women, 5 Jul)
2	WPL 2026 vs IPL 2026	**Both won by RCB**, but WPL was **5 Feb in Vadodara** (6 wickets), IPL **31 May in Ahmedabad** (5 wickets)
3	Asian Games 2026 (85) vs Hangzhou 2023 (record 28 gold, 100+ total)	2026 = **85 (21-27-37)**, 4th; **second-best ever**; don't answer "best ever"
4	Asian Games 85 vs Asian Para Games 114	Para Games = **114 (30-35-49)**, a record; both 4th place

#	Confusion	Correct fact
5	CWG 39 vs Asiad 85	CWG = **13-17-9 = 39**; Asiad = **21-27-37 = 85**
6	Asian Games 96 runs vs 147 runs	**96 runs** = T20 WC final vs NZ (Mar); **147 runs** = Asiad women's cricket final vs Sri Lanka (Sep)
7	Thomas Cup vs Uber Cup 2026	Thomas → **China (12th)**; Uber → **South Korea (3rd)**. India got **Thomas bronze**
8	Hockey World Cup men vs women	Men → **Germany (4th, equalled Pakistan)**, beat Spain 1–0; Women → **Argentina** on shootout vs Netherlands
9	World Cup 2026 champion vs Ballon d'Or 2026	**Spain** won the WC; **Harry Kane** (England) won the Ballon d'Or — Mbappé won Golden Boot, Rodri Golden Ball
10	Winter Olympics vs Winter Paralympics topper	**Norway** (18G) vs **China** (15G/44)
11	National Sports Awards "2025" announced in "2026"	Announced **18 Aug 2026** for the **2025** cycle; **no Khel Ratna**
12	Grand Slam 2026 "one Slam each"	**Zverev (RG + USO)** and **Rybakina (AO + USO)** won **two each**; Alcaraz missed RG/Wimbledon (wrist injury)
13	Asian Games host vs Asian Para Games host vs CWG host	Asiad & Para Asiad → **Aichi-Nagoya, Japan**; CWG → **Glasgow, Scotland**; Winter Games → **Milano-Cortina, Italy**
14	20th Asiad mascot vs 23rd CWG mascot	**HONOHON** (flame/Shachihoko) vs **Finnie** (unicorn)
15	FIFA mascots	**Three** (Maple/Zayu/Clutch) — first time a WC had three
16	Dakar 2026 = "Olympics in Africa"	It is the **Youth Olympic Games** (4th Summer YOG), the first **Olympic event** in Africa — not the senior Olympics
17	Doha 2030	Next Asian Games after Aichi-Nagoya 2026 → **Doha 2030** (Qatar, 2nd time)
18	India's first wrestling world champion	**Sushil Kumar (2010)** overall; **Manisha Bhanwala (2026)** = first Indian **woman**
19	U-19 WC / T20 WC / WPL / IPL 2026 title counts	Keep the ordinals separate: India **6th** U-19, India **3rd** T20 WC, RCB **2nd** WPL, RCB **2nd** IPL → **6 / 3 / 2 / 2**
20	"Mirabai Chanu won India's first CWG 2026 gold"	Yes — **26 July 2026, women's 48 kg, 190 kg**, completing a **hat-trick** of CWG golds

6. 60 RAPID-FIRE ONE-LINERS

1. 25th Winter Olympics → **Milano Cortina, Italy** (6–22 Feb 2026).
2. Winter Olympics 2026 motto → **"IT's Your Vibe"**.
3. Winter Olympics 2026 mascots → **Tina & Milo** (stoats).
4. Norway won **18 gold** at Milano Cortina 2026 — a record.
5. India's best Winter Olympics finish → **Arif Khan, 39th in men's slalom**.
6. Winter Paralympics 2026 topper → **China (15 gold, 44 total)**.
7. Wheelchair curling **mixed doubles** debuted at the 2026 Winter Paralympics.
8. Australian Open 2026 men → **Carlos Alcaraz** (Career Grand Slam, youngest ever).
9. Australian Open 2026 women → **Elena Rybakina** (2nd major).
10. French Open 2026 men → **Alexander Zverev** (first German Slam winner since Becker 1996).
11. French Open 2026 women → **Mirra Andreeva**, aged 19.
12. Wimbledon 2026 men → **Jannik Sinner** (5th major, defended).
13. Wimbledon 2026 women → **Linda Nosková** (first all-Czech Wimbledon final).
14. US Open 2026 → **Zverev & Rybakina**; $5.5 m each.
15. Rybakina became **World No. 1** after the 2026 US Open.
16. U-19 WC 2026 → **India's 6th title**, Zimbabwe & Namibia, beat England by 100 runs.
17. **Vaibhav Sooryavanshi** hit 175 off 80 in the U-19 final; 30 sixes in the tournament.
18. WPL 2026 → **RCB**, 2nd title, Vadodara, Mandhana 377 runs (Orange Cap).
19. Men's T20 WC 2026 → **India**, 3rd title, beat NZ by **96 runs** at Ahmedabad.
20. **Sanju Samson** = T20 WC 2026 Player of the Tournament (321 runs).
21. IPL 2026 → **RCB** beat **Gujarat Titans** by 5 wickets; back-to-back titles.
22. IPL 2026 Orange Cap → **Vaibhav Sooryavanshi (776)**; Purple Cap → **Kagiso Rabada (29)**.
23. Women's T20 WC 2026 → **Australia's 7th title**, Lord's, beat England by 7 wickets.
24. **Beth Mooney** = Player of the Match + Player of Series, WT20 WC 2026.
25. FIFA WC 2026 → **48 teams, 104 matches, 12 groups of 4, 16 venues, 3 hosts**.
26. FIFA WC 2026 final → **Spain 1–0 Argentina (a.e.t.)**, **Ferran Torres 106′**.

27. Spain won its **2nd** World Cup (first since 2010) and conceded just **one goal**.
28. FIFA WC 2026 Golden Boot → **Mbappé (10 goals)**; Golden Ball → **Rodri**.
29. FIFA WC 2026 Golden Glove → **Unai Simón**; Young Player → **Pau Cubarsí**.
30. England finished **3rd** (beat France 6–4) at WC 2026.
31. 2026 UCL final → **Puskás Aréna, Budapest**; **PSG** beat Arsenal on penalties.
32. AFC Women's Asian Cup 2026 → **Japan** beat Australia 1–0 (3rd title).
33. SAFF Women's Championship 2026 → **India's 6th title**, 3–1 vs Bangladesh in Goa.
34. CWG 2026 → **23rd edition, Glasgow, 23 Jul–2 Aug, 10 sports, mascot Finnie**.
35. CWG 2026 → India **4th, 39 medals (13-17-9)**; Australia 1st with 70 gold.
36. **Mirabai Chanu** = India's first CWG 2026 gold and a hat-trick of CWG golds.
37. India won **7 boxing golds** at CWG 2026 — a CWG record for the sport.
38. India's first-ever CWG judo golds → **Asmita Dey & Harsh Singh**.
39. Asian Games 2026 → **20th edition, Aichi-Nagoya, 19 Sep–4 Oct, mascot HONOHON**.
40. Asian Games 2026 motto → **"Imagine One Asia"**.
41. Asian Games 2026 → India **4th, 85 medals (21-27-37)**; China 169 gold / 341 total.
42. India's first Asiad 2026 gold → **women's T20 cricket** (beat Sri Lanka by 147 runs).
43. India completed the **cricket–hockey–kabaddi double** at Asiad 2026.
44. India's women won their **first Asiad hockey gold since 1982**.
45. **Pranavi Urs** = first Indian woman to win Asiad golf gold.
46. **Vithya Ramraj (54.75 s)** broke P.T. Usha's 42-year-old 400 m hurdles national record.
47. **Doha 2030** will host the next Asian Games (slogan The Games We Live For).
48. Asian Para Games 2026 → India **4th with a record 114 (30-35-49)**; 168 athletes.
49. **Sandeep's world record** (400 m T64, 52.28 s) fetched India's 100th Para Asiad medal.
50. **Smriti Mandhana** became India women's captain (all formats) on **6 Oct 2026**.
51. **Pankaj Advani** won his **29th world title** in billiards (23 Oct 2026).
52. **Manisha Bhanwala** = India's first woman wrestling world champion (59 kg, Astana).
53. **Harry Kane** won the **2026 Ballon d'Or** (70th, London); **Alexia Putellas** women's.
54. **Sourav Ganguly** entered the ICC Hall of Fame (8 Jul 2026) as the **12th Indian**.
55. National Sports Awards 2025 (announced 18 Aug 2026) → **no Khel Ratna, 17 Arjuna**.
56. **I. Arumainayagam** got the Arjuna (Lifetime) 2025; **Army Paralympic Node, Pune** got RKPP.
57. **Thomas Cup 2026 → China; Uber Cup 2026 → South Korea**; India = Thomas bronze.
58. **BWF Worlds 2026 → New Delhi**; **Treesa–Gayatri bronze**; Alex Lanier first French world champion.
59. **Praggnanandhaa** = first Indian to win **Norway Chess**; 46th Olympiad → Uzbekistan Open gold, India silver.
60. **Dakar 2026** (31 Oct–13 Nov) = **4th Summer YOG, first Olympic event in Africa**; **Dhinidhi Desinghu** won India's first-ever Olympic swimming medal (bronze, 2 Nov); **Kimi Antonelli** became F1's youngest champion (1 Nov).

7. PRACTICE MCQs (25) — with answer key & explanations

Q1. Who won the 2026 ICC Men's T20 World Cup, and by what margin in the final? A) Australia, by 7 wickets B) India, by 96 runs C) India, by 147 runs D) New Zealand, by 9 wickets

Q2. The 25th Winter Olympics (2026) were hosted by: A) Beijing, China B) Milano-Cortina, Italy C) Glasgow, Scotland D) Aichi-Nagoya, Japan

Q3. India's medal tally at the 2026 Commonwealth Games was: A) 85 (21-27-37) B) 114 (30-35-49) C) 39 (13-17-9) D) 41 (13-17-11)

Q4. Who was India's first gold medallist at Glasgow 2026? A) Lovlina Borgohain B) Neeraj Chopra C) Mirabai Chanu D) Jaismine Lamboria

Q5. The official mascot of the 20th Asian Games (Aichi-Nagoya 2026) was: A) Finnie B) HONOHON C) Tina D) Sheen-E-She

Q6. India finished at the 2026 Asian Games with: A) 3rd, 106 medals B) 4th, 85 medals C) 4th, 114 medals D) 5th, 80 medals

Q7. Which pair of countries co-hosted the 2026 ICC U-19 Men's Cricket World Cup? A) India & Sri Lanka B) Zimbabwe & Namibia C) England & Wales D) Belgium & Netherlands

Q8. Who won the 2026 FIFA World Cup final and who scored the winner? A) Argentina, Messi B) Spain, Ferran Torres C) France, Mbappé D) England, Kane

Q9. The 2026 Ballon d'Or was won by: A) Kylian Mbappé B) Lamine Yamal C) Rodri D) Harry Kane

Q10. Which team won the 2026 ICC Women's T20 World Cup? A) India B) England C) Australia D) New Zealand

Q11. The 2026 Wimbledon men's and women's singles champions were: A) Alcaraz & Rybakina B) Zverev & Andreeva C) Sinner & Nosková D) Sinner & Sabalenka

Q12. Thomas Cup 2026 and Uber Cup 2026 were won respectively by: A) China & China B) China & South Korea C) Denmark & Japan D) India & China

Q13. The 2026 Men's FIH Hockey World Cup was won by: A) Netherlands B) Argentina C) Germany D) Belgium

Q14. National Sports Awards announced on 18 August 2026 were notable because: A) 4 Khel Ratnas were awarded B) no Khel Ratna was awarded C) the Dhyan Chand Award was revived D) 32 Arjuna Awards were given

Q15. Who became the youngest-ever Formula 1 World Champion on 1 November 2026? A) George Russell B) Max Verstappen C) Kimi Antonelli D) Lando Norris

Q16. Dhinidhi Desinghu's bronze at Dakar 2026 was historic because: A) It was India's first Youth Olympics medal ever B) It was India's first-ever swimming medal at any Olympic event C) She was the youngest gold medallist D) India topped the medal table

Q17. Which city hosted the 2026 BWF World Championships (India's 2nd time hosting)? A) Hyderabad B) New Delhi C) Mumbai D) Pune

Q18. The 2026 Asian Para Games saw India win a record: A) 85 medals B) 108 medals C) 114 medals D) 39 medals

Q19. Who won the 2026 French Open men's singles title? A) Carlos Alcaraz B) Jannik Sinner C) Alexander Zverev D) Flavio Cobolli

Q20. The three mascots of the 2026 FIFA World Cup were: A) Tina, Milo, Flo B) Maple, Zayu, Clutch C) Finnie, Honohon, Pearl D) Maple, Zayu, Sheen

Q21. Who was appointed captain of the Indian women's cricket team on 6 October 2026? A) Harmanpreet Kaur B) Jemimah Rodrigues C) Smriti Mandhana D) Shafali Verma

Q22. The 2026 IPL Orange Cap and Purple Cap went to: A) Virat Kohli & Bhuvneshwar Kumar B) Vaibhav Sooryavanshi & Kagiso Rabada C) Shubman Gill & Rashid Khan D) Sanju Samson & Jasprit Bumrah

Q23. India's first-ever swimming medal at an Olympic event came in which event at Dakar 2026? A) Women's 200 m freestyle B) Women's 100 m freestyle C) Women's 50 m butterfly D) Men's 100 m backstroke

Q24. Which nation topped the 2026 Winter Paralympics medal table? A) Norway B) Italy C) China D) United States

Q25. Who won the FIDE Candidates Tournament 2026 to challenge D Gukesh? A) R Praggnanandhaa B) Javokhir Sindarov C) Anish Giri D) Hikaru Nakamura

Answer key + one-line explanations

Q	Ans	Why
1	**B**	India 255/5 bt NZ 159 by **96 runs**, 8 Mar, Ahmedabad (3rd title). 147 runs = Asiad women's cricket final.
2	**B**	Milano-Cortina, Italy, 6–22 Feb 2026 (25th Winter Games).
3	**C**	39 = 13G + 17S + 9B, 4th place; Australia 1st with 70 gold.
4	**C**	Mirabai Chanu, women's 48 kg weightlifting, 26 Jul, 190 kg — hat-trick (2018/2022/2026).
5	**B**	HONOHON (from honoho, flame). Finnie = CWG; Tina/Milo = Winter Olympics; Sheen-E-She = KIWG.
6	**B**	4th, 85 medals (21-27-37); China 169 gold; India's 2nd-best Asiad haul.
7	**B**	Zimbabwe & Namibia, 15 Jan–6 Feb 2026; India beat England by 100 runs at Harare.
8	**B**	Spain 1–0 Argentina a.e.t., Ferran Torres 106′, MetLife Stadium, 19 Jul.
9	**D**	Harry Kane (Bayern/England), first English winner since Owen 2001; Putellas women's.
10	**C**	Australia's 7th T20 WC title, beat England by 7 wickets at Lord's, 5 Jul.
11	**C**	Sinner (5th major) & Nosková (maiden major, all-Czech final), 29 Jun–12 Jul.
12	**B**	China 12th Thomas (3–1 France); South Korea 3rd Uber (3–1 China), both 3 May at Horsens.
13	**C**	Germany 1–0 Spain, 30 Aug, 4th title equalling Pakistan; women's champion was Argentina.
14	**B**	No Major Dhyan Chand Khel Ratna for the 2025 cycle; 17 Arjuna Awards, 5 Dronacharya.
15	**C**	Kimi Antonelli (Mercedes), 20y 68d, P3 in Mexico City; youngest ever, beating Vettel.
16	**B**	First Indian swimming medal at any Olympic event (senior or youth), bronze 100 m free, 56.27 s.
17	**B**	New Delhi, Indira Gandhi Indoor Stadium, 17–23 Aug (previous hosting: Hyderabad 2009).
18	**C**	114 (30G 35S 49B), 4th — bettered the 108 of Hangzhou 2023.
19	**C**	Zverev beat Cobolli in 5 sets for his 1st major; he also won the 2026 US Open.

Q	Ans	Why
20	**B**	Maple (Canada moose/GK), Zayu (Mexico jaguar/striker), Clutch (USA eagle/midfielder).
21	**C**	Smriti Mandhana replaced Harmanpreet Kaur across formats on 6 Oct 2026.
22	**B**	Sooryavanshi 776 runs (RR); Rabada 29 wickets (GT).
23	**B**	Women's 100 m freestyle, 56.27 s, 2 Nov 2026.
24	**C**	China: 15 gold / 44 total (Norway topped the Olympics, not the Paralympics).
25	**B**	Sindarov (Uzbekistan), unbeaten 9.5/13; title match vs Gukesh in Geneva from 25 Nov.

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Final revision advice

Revise **numbers + hosts + winners** from Section 1 and 3, drill **M1–M24** from Section 4, then read the **Trap Alerts** the night before the exam. Sports GA questions in 2026 will most likely be: "Who won…?", "Where was… hosted?", "How many medals…?", and "Which statement is incorrect?" — this file is built exactly for those four patterns.

Made for competitive-exam aspirants. All facts sourced from public reporting available up to 3 November 2026; see Section 8 for links.